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REVIEWS

Indoevropejskij jazyk i indoevropejcy: Rekonstrukcija i istoriko-tipologičeskij analiz prajazyka i protokul'tury. [The Indo-European language and the Indo-Europeans: Reconstruction and historical-typological analysis of a proto-language and a proto-culture.] By TAMAZ V. GAMKRELIDZE and VJAČESLAV V. IVANOV. With a preface by Roman Jakobson. 2 vols. Tbilisi: Izdatel'stvo Tbilisskogo Universiteta, 1984. Pp. xcvi, 1328. Rb. 4.80, 8.50.

Reviewed by BRENT VINE, *Yale University*

By now, the 'glottalic theory' of Indo-European consonantism requires no introduction to historical linguists, largely because of research by G&I over more than fifteen years (cf. Gamkrelidze & Ivanov 1973, Hopper 1973). This monumental work now presents the theory in greater detail, and offers G&I's views on numerous problems of IE linguistics and anthropology. The work's broad range of concern, is, however, something of a liability. It is true, as the jacket copy has it, that the work is of interest not only to linguists, but to 'anthropologists and ethnologists, archaeologists and cultural historians'; nevertheless, the bulk of Vol. I (and much of the argumentation of Vol. II) is comprehensible only to trained Indo-Europeanists. At the same time, highly simplified sections of both volumes make annoying reading for any linguist. G&I's wish to be taken seriously by a wide range of readers is undermined, then, by the difficulty—indeed, the impossibility—of presenting such complex material to such different audiences. I will return below to some suggestions for addressing this problem in future editions and translations. Apart from those suggestions, my remarks will concern Vol. I only, given the available space and this journal's readership.

The problem just mentioned is endemic to the extensive introductory matter. Thus the 'Survey of written sources' (xlvi–lvi) provides background information on the IE languages (and several contiguous non-IE ones) which is almost entirely gratuitous for Indo-Europeanists (and for many general linguists). The section is presumably designed to enable general linguists to follow G&I's argumentation and to familiarize readers with the primary sources, should they wish to check any of the data. But the presentation is uneven, and the selection principles are unclear; thus, in the matter of bibliography, the reader is sometimes directed to text editions, sometimes to broad discussions of language and cultural history, and sometimes to standard comparative grammars, without any apparent system.

The section on the transliteration systems used for languages with non-Latin orthographies (lvii–lxiii) is again otiose for Indo-Europeanists. G&I are to be commended for using Latin-alphabet transcriptions for most languages (as opposed to the Cyrillic-based transcriptions used in many Soviet publications); but an exception is Greek, which seems to contradict their aims concerning an intended general readership. Minor omissions, oversimplifications, and inconsistencies are inevitable in such schematic presentations; but some of these are troubling—bearing in mind, once again, the general linguist reader. Thus, in the presentation of the transcription system used for Avestan (lix–lx), G&I claim to use the 'standard' system; in actuality, they opt for a slightly modified version of the system found in older handbooks, instead of the simpler and now more widely used 'Hoffmann' system. For Italic (lxii), G&I mention Oscan *í* and *ú*, but they fail to note or to notate the important distinction between the native and Latin alphabets used in Umbrian. For Old Irish (lxii), G&I mention the more or less obvious facts that ⟨th⟩ = [θ], ⟨ch⟩ = [x], and ⟨V́⟩ = [V:]; but if uninitiated readers are to interpret Old Irish forms, they need to know facts that

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are less easily intuited, e.g. that orthographic voiceless segments may actually represent voiced ones because of lenition processes.

Following an extensive list of abbreviations, introductory essays address more substantive issues, such as 'The system of language and the prerequisites of diachronic linguistics' (lxxiii–xcvi). But much of the material is again superfluous. Sketchy preliminaries on the linguistic sign à la Saussure (lxxiii–lxxiv) are followed by a rather pedestrian account of some basic concepts of historical linguistics and their limitations (lxxv–lxxx); only afterward do we reach a discussion of the book's central theoretical claim, i.e. the notion of the 'typological verification of reconstructed models' (lxxx–lxxxv). In a gratingly repetitive style, G&I address the reality of reconstructions, their 'interpretation in space and time', and the status of typological verification in linguistic reconstruction. G&I take the strong position that 'If reconstructed models ... pretend to reflect anything that really existed ..., they must be in full accord with typological ... regularities', and that 'reconstructed linguistic models can be considered "real" under the following two basic typological criteria: agreement of the system with synchronic typological universals and agreement with diachronic typological universals' (lxxxi–lxxxiii). The result is that 'typological verification' is to be considered one of the most important prerequisites in evaluating linguistic structures. Most of the remaining introductory sections seem to be addressed to the non-linguist: a simplified account of the application of such concepts as distinctive features and markedness theory to phonetic reconstruction, couched in slightly post-*SPE* terms (lxxxv–xc); notes on fundamental principles of semantic reconstruction, with a predictable insistence on the 'typology of semantic transformations' (xc–xci); and remarks on the interpretation of dialectal differences (xci–xciii). A final section on the relationship between linguistic and cultural data (xciv–xcvi) amounts to a brief introduction to Vol. II.

Volume One's Part I, 'The phonological system and the morphophonemics of Common Indo-European', begins with the long Chap. 1, 'The three series of Indo-European stops: Paradigmatics and syntagmatics' (5–80). Since this chapter is concerned largely with familiar matters pertaining to the 'glottalic theory' of IE stops, I will survey it in some detail, so as to address certain general problems in the book's presentation. I will then give briefer surveys of the remaining chapters.

Chap. 1, Sec. 1, presents the traditional IE stop system, emphasizing the well-known gap caused by the virtual absence of securely reconstructable forms with **b*. Here and elsewhere, G&I base their quantitative data partly on the important but flawed statistical study of IE consonantism by Jucquois 1966. Although G&I express, in a general way, due caution about Jucquois' work (p. 7, n. 1), the importance which they assign it justifies a more thorough discussion of its nature and limitations, as well as the alternative hypotheses which emerge from Jucquois' data—e.g., the theory that the relatively high frequency of **m* may result from a pre-PIE merger of **b* and **m* is passed over in silence.

In Sec. 2, G&I present their 'typological interpretation' of the IE stop system, according to which the traditional voiced series represents ejectives (in which labials are typically lacking, cf. Greenberg 1970), while the traditional plain voiceless series represents voiceless aspirates (which forms a typologically natural counterpart to the traditional 'voiced aspirated' series, cf. Jakobson 1958). Finally, both the aspirated series are said to have unaspirated allophones—again, purely on the basis of typological evidence. But a lengthy footnote on the Austronesian language Kelabit (12, n. 1), which has been claimed to have a stop system like the one traditionally reconstructed for IE (see Blust 1973), suggests crucial issues of typological methodology which G&I fail to

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raise, much less discuss. They correctly point out that the claim regarding Kelabit rests on insufficiently detailed phonetic information; since aspiration in Kelabit is optional in certain positions, G&I are suspicious about the phonological status of aspiration, and they proceed to reanalyze the Kelabit data. Their suspicions may well be justified, but this is not the point. Suppose Kelabit does turn out to have a stop system comparable to that of 'traditional' IE, or suppose another language or two (or ten) turn out to have such a system: how will this affect the argumentation? What, precisely, are the theoretical—indeed, the statistical—assumptions of 'typological verification'? A more rigorous approach to the patterning of phonological inventories is clearly called for, and has begun to emerge in recent years (cf. Maddieson 1984, Bell 1986).

In Sec. 3, G&I reformulate, in terms of the new system, the well-known cooccurrence restrictions governing initial and final stops in IE roots; and they offer typological support for some, but not all, of these patterns. Thus the constraint against roots of the shape T'ET' (traditional DED) can be supported on the basis of typological data from languages with ejectives; but the constraint against D^hET^h and T^hED^h (traditional D^hET and TED^h)—vs. the possible shapes $T'ET^h$, T^hET', D^hED^h and T^hET^h (traditional DET, TED, D^hED^h and TET)—remains unexplained, apart from speculations about the incompatibility of voiced and voiceless segments within a root (20).

In Sec. 4, given G&I's claim that the plain voiced and voiceless series have both aspirated and unaspirated allophones, they 'explain' a number of phenomena involving aspiration by setting up rules for the allophonic distribution of aspiration, both in IE and in the individual languages. Thus Grassmann's Law in Indic and Greek reflects not one or more einzelsprachlich dissimilatory processes of deaspiration, but rather an original IE pattern of allophonic distribution in roots: a root may contain only one voiced aspirated consonant. But such a statement must be described, in G&I's words (23), in terms of 'areal features' of IE, since initial deaspiration is characteristic only of Greek and Indic; other areas (e.g. Italic and Germanic) seem to show deaspiration of the root-FINAL consonant. In point of fact, as G&I admit (24; 25, n. 1), the Indic situation regarding Grassmann's Law is considerably more complex than their simplified treatment makes it appear.[1] In similar fashion, a number of assimilatory phenomena (principally Bartholomae's Law) are reformulated as IE processes; but given the phonetically trivial nature of most of these processes, G&I's strong assertions about gains in simplicity (34) are not convincing.

Sec. 5 provides a detailed overview of how the postulated stop system has developed in the various IE languages, with reformulations of a number of well-known phenomena in individual languages. As with the Kelabit remarks, however, important issues are often casually skirted in footnotes. According to G&I, the consonant systems of Germanic and Armenian continue the postulated IE system virtually intact; this eliminates the need both for Grimm's Law and for the complex sound shifts traditionally required to explain Ar-

[1] Besides Whitney 1889, they refer only to Anderson 1970 and to Phelps & Brame 1973—ignoring the substantial later generative literature on the subject, including the important descriptive and theoretical analysis of Schindler 1976.

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menian. G&I suggest, in fact, that the original ejective series was 'possibly' still characterized by glottal articulation in Proto-Germanic (35); and they add in a footnote that 'it might be possible to see traces of this glottal articulation ... in certain prosodic features reflected in the late Germanic languages' (such as the Danish stød). This line of argument is not pursued, except for the addition of several typological parallels; and yet what is called for is a detailed demonstration that such late Germanic prosodic phenomena can only be explained by assuming an original glottalized series in Proto-Germanic. It is all the more annoying, then, to see that G&I adduce these late Germanic phenomena again and again as supportive parallels to other equally speculative patterns in other languages.[2] Similarly, G&I note that, if the plain voiceless series of Classical Armenian was actually glottalized (as in some modern Armenian dialects), then the classical language would preserve the original ejective series directly. But consideration of this controversial hypothesis about Classical Armenian is relegated to a footnote (41, n. 2)—even though this is precisely the sort of material the reader needs in order to be convinced of the necessity for setting up a PIE ejective series.

The discussion of Anatolian (45 ff.) includes provocative but largely speculative remarks on various phonetic details—including aspiration (which is seen as the phonetic feature behind Sturtevant's Law in Hittite), assibilation, non-distinctive glottalization, and palatalized segments. But the nature of the discussion does not warrant the strength of G&I's conclusions concerning Hittite and Proto-Anatolian phonetics (48–9). In a half-page discussion of Tocharian (49), they argue that traces of the original three consonant series are apparent in the three differently assibilated reflexes of IE *t' *d^h *t^h (in their system); but they fail to mention, much less to explain, any of the problems surrounding the non-assibilated forms, especially those of IE *t' (traditional *d)—except to say 'cf. the different interpretation in Winter 1962'.

In Indo-Iranian, Greek, Italic, Celtic and Balto-Slavic, G&I's (voiceless) ejectives end up as a voiced series; this is defended (49–52) on the basis of general phonetic and typological considerations. In Greek, however, the 'voiced aspirated' (i.e. murmured or 'breathy-voiced') series ends up as voiceless—and this, too, it turns out, can be similarly justified (60 ff.) It has often been noted that the glottalic theory, with its more 'natural' inventory of IE consonants, typically leads to trade-off situations: here, for example (as G&I themselves note, 80), we are essentially exchanging the Germanic and Armenian consonant shifts for a number of other shifts in Indo-Iranian, Greek etc. However, as I have suggested with reference to Kelabit, the piling up (or the absence) of typological parallels does not of itself constitute a satisfactory methodology for 'typological verification'. Nor are we reassured by G&I's constant assertions, without further support, that a certain form or feature reflects a 'trace' of something original. In Indic, although the ejective series has ended up as voiced (e.g. Skt. *ad-* 'eat' < **et'*-), we are told (52) that assimilations like *átti* 'he eats' (< **et'-t^{h}i*) show a trace of the original voiceless character of the ejective series. But such forms could also result from a voicing assimilation of the most trivial kind, if we assume original **d*. In Greek, we are told (59, n. 1), traces of the original unvoiced character of the ejective series appear in a few isolated forms like *prókhnu* 'kneeling' (cf. *gónu* 'knee'); but what, one may ask, are the other forms? (And what about the extensive literature on *prókhnu* itself, none of which is mentioned?) Is it the case that all these forms are best accounted for by positing original voiceless segments?

[2] Thus, in the discussion of Lachmann's Law, we are told (69) that the vowel length in forms like Latin *āctus* is a result of compensatory lengthening, from the loss of the glottalic feature in an original sequence **ak't^{h}os*. In the discussion of Winter's 1979 lengthening law for Balto-Slavic (76), we are told that the lengthening and acute intonation of short vowels before original ejectives is again a direct result of the loss of the glottalic feature. Both the Latin and the Balto-Slavic processes are supported with reference to the unproved Germanic ones.

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G&I conclude Chap. 1 with remarks on Grimm's Law—which, they say (79–80), 'turns out to be inadequate in relation to the phonological processes that must have taken place in Germanic'. But this is precisely what they have not shown: neither is Grimm's Law 'inadequate' to explain the facts of Germanic consonantism, nor have G&I demonstrated that other phonological (e.g. prosodic) processes REQUIRE a primordial IE source of the type they claim.

G&I's constant concern with 'phonetic naturalness' often amounts to an overriding predilection, not always rigorously justified, for symmetry. In Chap. 2, 'Place series of the IE stop system and the class of sibilant spirants' (81–151), G&I first reconstruct the IE 'gutturals'; they arrive at three series—velar, labiovelar, and palatal (in common with one traditional version of IE consonant theory)—and then discuss certain problems surrounding the *centum/satəm* distinction. More controversial is their reconstruction (116–34) of a palatal sibilant **ś* and a labialized sibilant **s*^{w}, in addition to plain **s*, producing a three-way sibilant system symmetrical with that of the gutturals. The palatal sibilant is based on Indic forms which lack an initial sibilant corresponding to forms with sibilant elsewhere (type Skt. *páśyati* vs. Gk. *sképtomai*, La. *specio*; cf. also Vedic perf. *paspaśé*). Although this alternation is certainly real, it is not clear that it justifies reconstructing such a segment, or that a palatal sibilant has enough other desirable consequences—beyond filling out the system. G&I's labialized sibilant is based on forms that appear to show initial alternations **s-/*su̯-/*u̯-*, as in 'six' (e.g. Gaulish *suexos*, Welsh *chweched*, Avestan *xšvaš*, Armenian *vec'*, beside the forms with initial **s-*: La. *sex* etc.) But the precise elationship of this labialized segment with surface **s-*, **su̯-* and **u̯-* is not explored in any detail; so the nature of these alternations remains fundamentally unclear. Still more speculative are alleged traces of IE postvelar and labiodental series (129–34), seen in certain sporadic alternations—despite G&I's detailed comparison (134–9) with systems showing typological similarity to the postulated IE system (Kartvelian, Abxaz, Semitic).

The next two chapters examine a number of important questions concerning the rest of the IE phonological system, and IE morphophonemics generally. In Chap. 3, 'The vowel system and the theory of morphophonemic alternations: Sonants and "laryngeals" in Indo-European' (152–214), G&I propose an elaborate scenario for the development of IE ablaut alternations, including remarks on a number of *o*-grade and lengthened-grade categories (172 ff.) The chapter concludes with a discussion of Sievers–Edgerton phenomena and of various reflexes of sonants and laryngeals—especially syllabic R̥, R̥H treatments, and laryngeal vocalizations.[3] For Indo-Europeanists, the most interesting part of Chap. 4, 'The structure of the Indo-European root' (215–63), is the extended discussion of Benvenistean 'State II' formations and the problem of IE Schwebeablaut (222–52). Finally, G&I compare their views on IE phonology and morphophonemics with a detailed typological presentation of Kartvelian root structure, velarized and labialized consonants, reduplication, morphological alternations, and resonants.

[3] Predictably, G&I operate (as do some other scholars) with a phonetically specified triplet of laryngeals which is perfectly symmetrical with the gutturals and sibilants, as discussed above: H_2 is neutral, H_1 is palatal, and H_3 is labial.

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Part II, 'Analysis of the grammatical structure of Common Indo-European', begins with Chap. 5, 'Proto-Indo-European as a language of active typology' (267–319). Here G&I attempt to explain, in highly speculative fashion, much of IE nominal and verbal morphology in terms of an original binary opposition between 'active' and 'inactive' terms (roughly comparable to 'animate' and 'inanimate'). In Chap. 6, 'Typology of the grammatical syntagmatics of Common Indo-European' (320–68), they explore the 'structural implications' of IE as an SOV language—with discussions of the defining features of IE verbal morphology (primary/secondary endings, active/middle, thematic/athematic, optative/subjunctive/causative etc.), relative and attributive constructions, and the system of adverbs and verbal particles. The chapter concludes with remarks on the structure of the simple sentence in IE.

Part III, 'Areal structures of Common Indo-European', consists of Chap. 7, 'Articulation of the Indo-European linguistic zone' (371–428). Here we find extensive (but relatively uncontroversial) listings of phonological, grammatical, and lexical isoglosses, culminating in a number of diagrams designed to show IE dialect relationships both spatially and chronologically.

In many ways, this volume is a marvel of organization and presentation: the extraordinarily detailed table of contents in the front of the book (which covers no less than 29 pages), the thorough *Language*-style bibliography, the remarkably extensive and useful set of indices (which alone take up 200 pages), and the virtual absence of typographical errors set standards rarely achieved in Western publications (and almost unheard of in Soviet publications). Both G&I and the Tbilisi State University are to be congratulated. Other features are less impressive, although perhaps understandable: the almost embarrassing use of what could be called 'MIT buzzwords of the 60's',[4] the simplified and generally needless distinctive feature matrices, the grinding repetition (especially when typological matters are discussed), and the general problem of the book's intended audience.[5]

More serious is the tendency to skirt crucial issues of typological methodology, along with the constant, almost imperceptible (and therefore insidious) vacillation from close linguistic argumentation to vague speculation, from exposition of a theory to pontifical assertion of its correctness. These are more than stylistic weaknesses. Nevertheless, as G&I themselves note in their preface (ix–x), this is not a new handbook of Indo-European: it is an investigation of a number of restricted questions of Indo-European linguistic structure and typology. It is, we should add, the richest and most important investigation of its kind—in Jakobson's just words (xvi),[6] a 'remarkable work' from which 'many fruitful discussions will arise'.[7]

[4] On the first page of G&I's preface (ix), we find phrases like 'greater explanatory power', 'purely taxonomic', 'deep structures', etc.

[5] This last problem might be solved relatively easily by issuing the work in separate sections, and with some of the material transposed. One volume, directed to a linguistic audience, might contain most of the material in Vol. I—but without the simplified and patronizing parts of the introductory matter, and combined with the last section of Vol. II (859–969), in which G&I present their views on important questions of IE dialectology. Another volume, directed to non-linguists, would contain most of what appears in Vol. II, but with a detechnicalized presentation, perhaps preceded by essays introducing those linguistic concepts needed to follow the argumentation.

[6] Jakobson's preface, written in 1979, is now available in English (minus the last paragraph), as Jakobson 1985.

[7] [An English translation of the work under review here, prepared by Johanna Nichols, has been announced for publication by Mouton de Gruyter, Berlin. —ED.]

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Language, status, and power in Iran. By WILLIAM O. BEEMAN. Bloomington Indiana University Press, 1986. Pp. xx, 255.

Reviewed by JOHN MOYNE, *CUNY Graduate Center*

There has been a significant upsurge in interest in Iran during the last decade, particularly since recent events have hit at the heart of American politics. Beeman's book is therefore a welcome and timely treatise on social and anthropological-linguistic aspects of Persian language and communication. Referring to the 'deep-rooted' cultural structure of the Iranian society, he attempts to explain recent revolutionary events in the light of traditional beliefs and values, especially as these are reflected in everyday language communication:

> 'The rhetoric of the revolutionary leaders was powerful because it dealt with the core symbolic issues of Iranian civilization as described throughout this study—the internal versus the external, hierarchy versus equality. The Pahlavi regime and even some of the nationalist intellectuals that replaced the Pahlavis in the first government following their deposition were insensitive to these issues, and they spoke to Iranian citizens in terms of an alien, largely western set of categories—modern versus traditional, world power versus second-class nation,

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